

AI TOOLS AND STUDENTS' UNDERSTANDING OF INTERNATIONAL ISSUES

Community (Social) Project Presentation

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FIELD OF STUDY: INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

VIZJA UNIVERSITY

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UNDER THE SUPERVISION OF J. PATRICK HIGGINS, UV

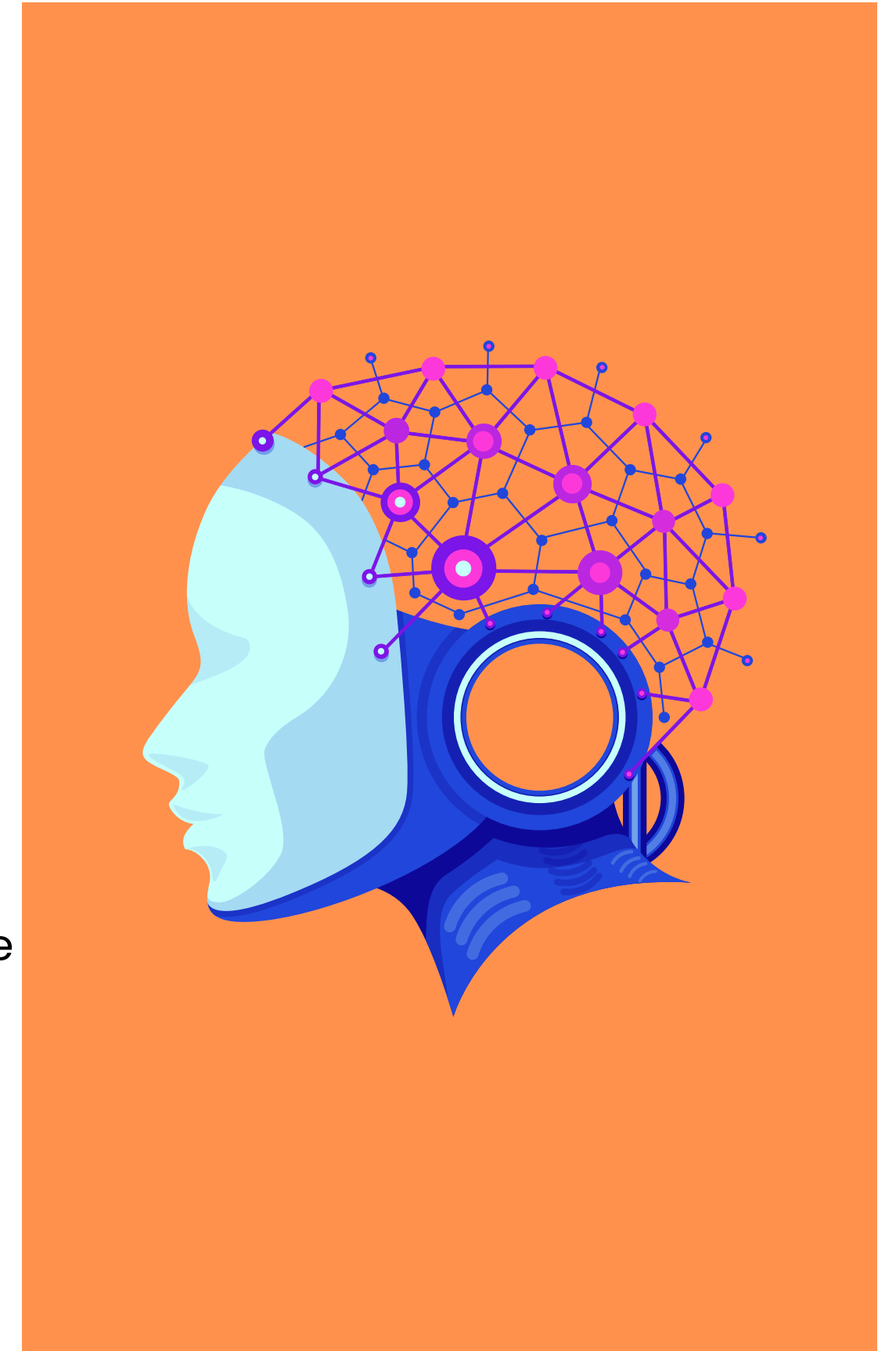


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PROJECT BACKGROUND

Why This Project Matters

- AI tools are now common in students' academic work.
- They make information faster and easier to access.
- However, AI can also create risks such as misinformation, bias, and fake references.
- This is important in International Relations, because students need accurate information to understand global issues.
- For this reason, students should learn how to use AI critically and responsibly.



AIM AND TARGET GROUP

Main Aim

- To understand how university students use AI tools to study international issues.
- To identify risks such as misinformation, bias, and over-trust in AI answers.
- To support students with a simple Responsible AI Guide.

Target Group

- University students aged 18–25.
- Students from VIZJA University and international student networks.
- Students who use AI for academic work and global political information.



METHODOLOGY AND PROJECT PROCESS

- The project followed a simple research and practice-based process.
- First, I prepared the research framework and survey questions.
- Then, I shared the survey in Turkish and English versions.
- After collecting the answers, I analyzed the main findings.
- Finally, I created the Responsible AI Guide and collected student feedback.

Research Framework

Survey

Data Analysis

AI Guide

Student Feedback



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MAIN SURVEY FINDINGS

- 62 students completed the survey.
- 72.6% use AI tools daily or several times per week.
- 71% have seen false or misleading AI-generated information.
- Only 8.1% always verify AI-generated information.
- This shows a clear verification gap among students.

KEY SURVEY RESULTS

Finding	Percentage
Frequent AI use	72.6%
Misleading AI information encountered	71%
Always verify AI information	8.1%



Responsible AI Guide for Students

For academic research and understanding global political issues

Survey basis: project data collected in Turkish (n=28) and English (n=34), March 2026.

Core Rule

AI may help save time and explain complicated issues, yet it may give false, biased, or unproven statements. Use AI as a starting point - not a final authority.

Survey Snapshot

72.6% uses AI on a daily or multiple times a week academic basis.

Only 62.9% use AI often or sometimes in order to comprehend international.

71.0% have been aware of false or misleading AI output.

Always AI-generated information is checked by only 8.1 percent, 79.0 percent of them.

TRACE Verification Checklist

T - Notice of the original source, author and publication.

R - Check date, situation and is it one of fact or interpretation.

A - Evaluate potential bias, framing, lost voices, or partisanism.

C - Triangle with two or more credible and independent sources.

E - Be able to explain the point using your own words before you can use it in your work.

When Checking Political Information

Date, actors, institutions, treaties, and quotes. before using the claim.

Personal fact, interpretation, and forecasting - AI is likely to disorient them.

Official sources along with reliable news should be used in addition to official sources in case of conflicts, elections, and diplomatic crises.

Notice taking advantage and framing one side or making a reaction to historical context.

Red Flags

No sources, never ambiguous, vague or experts say.

No reference or reference you cannot find.

A domineering reaction where there exists a single political perception.

Articles which seem to be scholarly yet have unrealistic titles, authors or DOIs.

An essay whose paragraph is glossed and reads as though it has been cut-pasted, and has no support.

Academic Integrity and Critical Thinking

The AI may be employed in the process of brainstorming, simplification, comparison of opinions and the generation of questions.

Do not submit the writing of AI as your original and authoritative conclusion or the writing that will be attributed to you as part of you.

Confirm each reference personally and keep your judgment and words and conclusion.

Publish AI application where course regulations require it.

Final Reminder

Fast does not mean reliable. Responsible AI use = speed + verification + transparency.

RESPONSIBLE AI GUIDE

- Based on the survey findings, I created a short and practical guide for students.
- The guide explains that AI should be used as a starting point, not a final authority.
- It includes red flags for unreliable AI answers and simple verification tips.
- It also presents the TRACE checklist and reminders about academic integrity.
- The aim of the guide was to help students use AI more critically and safely.



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FEEDBACK AND RESULT INDICATORS

- 14 students completed the feedback form.
- 92.9% said the guide helped them use AI more critically.
- 78.6% said they are more likely to verify AI-generated information.
- All respondents found the guide easy or mostly easy to understand.
- The project reached its planned results and even exceeded some targets.

Planned vs. Achieved Results

Indicator	Planned Target	Achieved result
Student survey	30–50 responses	62 responses
Responsible AI Guide	Created and shared	Completed
Student feedback	5–10 responses	14 responses



CONCLUSION

- AI tools are useful for students, but they should not be trusted blindly.
- The main problem found in the project was the verification gap.
- Students use AI often, but many do not check AI-generated information regularly.
- The Responsible AI Guide supported more critical and responsible AI use.
- The project achieved its main goals: survey, guide creation, and student feedback.
- In the future, the guide could be improved with better design and clearer tracking of its reach.
- A small limitation was the lack of exact download or click data for the guide.

